
PROFESSIONALISM

What Does Professionalism Mean?

- Character
- Attitude
- Conduct
- Competency
- Communication
- Relationship Building
- Appearance



Character

- Responsibility
- Accountability
- Integrity



Attitude

- Be positive: avoid complaining and arguing
- Develop a “problem-solving mindset”
- Be courteous and polite
- Be proactive: demonstrate willingness
- Practice good manners
- Be humble: avoid sense of entitlement



Competency

- Demonstrate the skills you have learned and polish them where needed
- Take initiative to learn new skills
- Self Regulation: Remain professional even when under pressure
- Apply knowledge-based decision making
- Know the Requirements of your program, internship or workplace. Be responsible for seeking out resources.

Communication

- Keep it simple, say what you need or want

Email:

- Use respect, be kind but professional
- Include a subject line, greeting and sign off

In person:

- Be focused on your conversation, avoid multi-tasking
- Know and use the individual's name

When in doubt, opt for the most formal approach.



Conduct

- Punctuality
- Attendance
- Respect and consideration
- Stick to your word

“Early is on time, on time is late and late is unacceptable.”

“Better late than never, but never late is better.”

Relationship Building

- Be a team player – group projects are great practice
- Give appreciation – be encouraging and give credit where credit is due
- Maintain professional boundaries
- Network – build your professional connections

Appearance

- First impressions are important
- Conservative is key
- Be aware of your surroundings, you never know who is in the room with you
- When in doubt, opt for the more formal approach.
- Be conscientious of your online presence